

HCL Beanstalk 4658 and Zenith Premium PC

Tug-of-brand

These PCs from Zenith and HCL had the best configuration of them all. The basic difference between them and the rest, was the high performance hardware, which delivered on all counts.

While the Zenith Performance PC offered the Pentium 4 3.2 GHz, while the HCL Beanstalk 4658 settled for the Pentium 4 2.4 GHz. Both processors support 800 MHz FSB and Hyperthreading. In the processor sub-system tests, the Pentium 4 3.2 GHz crushed all records to come out tops, followed by the HCL system.

Both used top-notch motherboards—Zenith has Intel’s 865GBF motherboard, whereas HCL uses the Asus P4P800, which supports dual-channel DDR 400 MHz memory, AGP 8X and has extra features such as onboard six-channel sound, LAN controller, USB 2.0 ports, etc. In addition, the Zenith system has 512 MB of DDR 400 MHz memory modules, whereas the HCL is content with 256 MB. Both machines were configured in dual-channel mode. The Zenith, due to its higher clock processor, was better at extracting the most out of the memory, but the difference between the two was not significant.

The HCL PC boasts of the Ennyah GeForce Fx-5200 graphics card, while the Zenith PC comes with just an Asus Ge Force4 MX 440-8X card. The DirectX 9-compliant FX-5200 lets you play all the latest games with the eye-candy switched on. The GeForce4 MX 440 is DirectX 8.1-compliant, implying that the eye-candy will be rendered by



The HCL Beanstalk 4658 did a marvellous job on the gaming front

Price: Rs 51,490
+ Great package
- None

HCL Beanstalk 4658	B
Performance	■ ■ ■ ■ ■
Features	■ ■ ■ ■ ■
Build quality	■ ■ ■ ■ ■
Value for money	■ ■ ■ ■ ■

PowerMac G5

The Power Mac G5 is the latest and the most powerful addition to the Power Mac range of workstations. The single most discerning attribute is the fact that it’s powered by the G5 processor—the world’s first 64-bit processor for the desktop computer.

Keeping up with tradition, Apple has never compromise on its design and features. The handles on the top of the case are of great help to carry it around. Its titanium-coloured case is divided into four separate zones on the basis of the operating temperature. This eliminates the need for powerful fans and leads to a quieter system. The Power Mac G5 also comes with the now ubiquitous SuperDrive, as well as support for USB 2.0 and FireWire. Wi-Fi connectivity is also supported through Apple’s own Airport Extreme device.

Its true potentials remain hooded, due to the absence of a 64-bit OS. Sometime soon, the emergence of a 64-bit operating system will unveil the difference of 64-bit processing on your desktop.



the CPU. However, the Zenith PC took a good lead while playing *Quake III* at lower resolutions, where the processing is passed on to the processor, but the FX-5200 card showed its mettle at higher resolutions, scoring marginally over the Zenith. Overall, both these PCs are better at gaming than the rest of the crowd, and provide playable frame rates. The small margin by which the hard disk on the Zenith PC performs better than the one on the HCL system gave it a lead in the multi-tasking test. It opened a 200 MB TIFF



The Zenith Performane PC came with a sleek LCD monitor

file from the hard disk in just 23 seconds—less than half the time taken by the HCL PC. Though the credit for this was shared by the higher clock processor, it shows how a fast hard disk can boost the PC’s overall performance.

While the HCL PC came with a 17-inch flat screen CRT monitor, the Zenith PC stood out from rest with its crisp, extremely good-looking 17-inch LCD. The HCL PC also brought along a combination drive, headphones and a 56k PCI modem—all of which the Zenith missed.

As for software, the HCL PC came with Windows XP Home Edition, Ankur pro Office suite, the Microsoft Encarta encyclopedia and lots of other applications. As for the Zenith PC, neither is an operating system, nor additional software provided. Instead, it provides a customised software package for which you need to pay extra.

Zenith’s powerhouse is priced at Rs 60,000, excluding local taxes and the cost of the software, whereas the HCL costs Rs 51,490. In terms of performance, the Zenith PC beats the HCL by a significant margin. Yet,



Decision Maker

	Entry-Level PCs	Low-End PCs	Mid-Level PCs
You need	A PC for browsing the Internet, basic office work and playing MP3s, audio CDs and video CDs.	A PC that can be used in the office, can indulge into occasional gaming sessions and be used for entertainment purposes.	One that runs all the latest and upcoming games, works with professional applications such as Photoshop without hiccups, and does a whole lot of multi-tasking.
Look for	A PC with 1.7 GHz processor, 128 MB DDR RAM, a 40 GB hard disk, integrated six-channel audio, decent speakers and onboard graphics	A PC with a 2.4 GHz processor, 256 MB DDR RAM, a 7200 RPM 40 GB hard drive, and if possible, a graphics card and onboard six-channel sound with decent speakers	A PC with a processor above 2.4 GHz, with features such as 800 FSB and Hyperthreading, more than 256 MB of DDR RAM, a DirectX 9-compliant graphics card and a 7,200 rpm hard disk
Our pick	HCL Ezeabee, Compaq S5010iL and Zenith Home PC	Compaq S5030iL, Dart Emerald performance PC	HCL Beanstalk 4658, Zenith Performance PC
Price	Upto Rs 30,000	From Rs 31,000 to Rs 45,000	Above Rs 45,000